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-ELIN NORDEGREN

EXERCISE BOOK

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Grade 10

Subject:

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LEAVES

1. Donald Davidson's Argument.

2. G.E. Moore's Argument.

3. The Logical positivism and logical atomism (comparison)

4. Why is analysis important in Analytic philosophy

5. Frege's Argument

6. A Concise discuss of analytic philosophy - "The Key argument of different phases."

The arguments of G. E. Moore - "Defense of Common ^{Sense} belief"

Outline.

1.0. Introduction

2.0. Clarification of terms.

2.1. Early phase of analytic philosophy.

2.2. Common sense belief.

3.0. G. E. Moore's standpoint on commonsense belief.

4.0. Evaluation

5.0. Conclusion.

INTRODUCTION.

Classification of terms.

Early Phase of analytic philosophy.

This phase is known for the emphasis on the use of formalism and informalism; thus, the use of logical symbols and the use of concepts from everyday language respectively. It aims to facilitate linguistic and logical analysis. Proponents of this early phase are G.E. Moore and Frege.

Common Sense Belief.

Common sense belief is a belief which every man knows to be true. It is a widely shared belief about the social and natural world, which is held by the lay members of the society. For instance the statement "My father is older than me" is generally known to be true. Thus, the statement is a common sense belief.

G. E. Moore's Defense of Common sense Belief

(1852-1933)

G.E Moore's Defense of Common sense belief was motivated by his rejection of idealism and skepticism that was prevalent at that time.

He was deeply concerned with absolute certainty and the doubts of some philosophers on the existence of the external world, and even the reliability of our knowledge of them.

His philosophical discuss on analytic philosophy and common sense could be traced to the discuss and dialogue he had with McTaggart in Bertrand Russell's office at Oxford University. In their discourse, McTaggart stated that "Time is unreal". Moore pointed this out and noted that the statement contradicts common sense belief, because it is idealistic and metaphysical.

Moore hence was inspired to buttress his argument on common sense belief, as such he wrote the work "The defense of Common sense belief".

In his work, Moore refuted every philosophical tradition or theory that contradicts common sense belief. on the basis that every meaningful proposition must be clear, distinct and precise. For him, whatever doesn't conform to our common sense experience should be discarded.

He debunked some philosophical traditions like Absolute Skepticism and idealism because they question

the reliability and possibility of human knowledge and belief.

In order to prove his standpoint on common sense belief, Moore proposed an argument which he termed to be undeniable, thus using the argument of his "hand" as part of his physical body to try and prove the certainty and reliability of common sense beliefs.

Also, he noted that when a commonly believed statement is made, there is no justifiable reason to prove that it is false.

Themes in his Arguments on the Certainty of Common Sense.

1. Affirmation of Common sense Realism.

This is his argument that our ordinary, common sense view of the world is largely correct. He asserts that there are certain propositions about the world that are self-evidently true, for instance the existence of physical objects and the continuity of earth's existence.

This affirmation of common sense, serves as a direct counter to the idealist and skeptical positions that question the existence of an external world.

2. Usage of Copulas.

A notable aspect of Moore's philosophical approach is his use of copulas (the verb "to be" in various forms) in asserting the truth of common-sense propositions. His reliance on simple declarative statements, such as "This is a hand" or "The earth is round" highlights his emphasis on direct, unambiguous expressions of truth.

For him the usage of copulas in expression don't establish a relation of identity. He opined that the usage of copulas to express identity ends up in "naturalistic fallacy".

3. Rejection of philosophical Skepticism.

Moore's work challenges the foundations of philosophical skepticism, particularly the idea that we cannot have certain knowledge of the the external world.

For him, the fact that people know certain truths with certainty undermines skeptical arguments that question the existence of an external world.

4. Separation of truth and Analysis

A key distinction in Moore's philosophy is between truth of common sense and philosophical analysis. He

affirms that truth and knowability of common sense
but remains open to various philosophical analysis; for
instance his belief that the phenomenalist analysis of
physical objects might be ~~but~~ correct as long as it does
not contradict fundamental truths.

EVALUATION.

Donald Davidson's Argument.

1.0. Introduction.

2.0. Classification of Terms — Modern analytic philosophy
Theory of truth.

3.0. Donald Davidson's Argument.

3.1. Alfred Tarski's Theory of truth.

3.2. Donald Davidson's explanation of Alfred Tarski's theory

4.0. Salient points in Davidson's stance.

5.0. Evaluation

6.0. Conclusion.

Introduction.

Clarification of thought terms:

Modern Analytic philosophy.

This is the first and last stage of analytic philosophy. Anthony Quinton describes it as a phase in which thinking and writing are respectful of science both as a paradigm of reasonable belief and in conformity with its argumentative rigor, clarity and determination to be objective.

Proponents of this era include, Peter Strawson, Saul Kripke, Scott Soames, W.V. Quine and Donald Davidson.

THEORY OF TRUTH.

Donald Davidson's arguments (1917-2003)

Davidson's project explores and defends Tarski-style of theory of truth for a language. According to him, Tarski's theory suffices to explain how the meanings of the sentences of a language (L) depends upon the meaning of words of L , and thus models a significant part of the knowledge someone possesses when she understands L .

Davidson's claim is that we can adopt a Tarski-style theory of truth for a theory of meaning.

Tarski's Theory of Truth;

Alfred Tarski's theory of truth focuses on separating adequate theories of truth from the inadequate ones. (he calls this stance: Convention T)

According to him, the truth-predicate (T_P) cannot be expressed in the object language (i.e., language to be interpreted) otherwise the language will fall prey to such paradoxes as the Liar paradox.

T_P is a predicate of metalanguage, that describes statements in the object language. For example, the truth predicate of the object-language "Schnee is weiss" is the underlined words in this metalanguage

that contains the predicate "is true". (Snow is white is true) if snow is really white.

So, a translated sentence can be proven to be true in metalanguage if and only if it is part of the object language (i.e. T_p must apply to it)

The questions of great importance in Tarski's theory are.

A. What makes a particular truth predicate an adequate definition of truth?

B. What are the criteria that a particular theory of truth must satisfy in order to be considered an adequate definition of truth?

Tarski responded by analysing the concept of truth in terms of the concept of meaning (i.e. Truth as meaning; i.e. a sentence is true if its meaning is actually what it conveys.

Donald Davidson's

Davidson in contrast to Tarski's position, explains the notion of meaning in terms of truth (i.e., meaning

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Donald Davidson's

Davidson in contrast to Tarski's position, explains the notion of meaning in terms of truth (i.e., meaning

derived from T sentences or metalanguage are True).

As such, a Davidsonian theory of meaning is an empirical theory that one constructs to interpret, describe, systematize and explain linguistic behaviour of speakers. It is a descriptive semantics that shows how to construct the meaning of a speaker's sentences out of the meanings of their parts and how those parts are assembled.

One can think of a Davidsonian theory of meaning for the language L as a set of axioms (propositions) that assign meanings to the lexical elements of the language and which, together with rules for constructing complex expressions of L, imply theorems of the form:

For example, '419' is a number generally but it is a colloquial expression for fraudster in Nigeria. Also, when someone says, 'I am coming while moving away', it means that they will join you later. However, its generally meaning is that the person is walking towards you.

The expressions above give the assumption that the aforementioned linguistic expressions represent the facts of the world, which is not the case.

* A truth-conditional-theory-sentence represents facts or states of affairs in the world, names referred to, objects

and so forth. The emphasis on sentences is because they constitute the most basic units of information.

For instance, "Albert Ikpenwa" does not seem to say anything when uttered until we point at someone and say, "This is Albert Ikpenwa" or "Albert Ikpenwa is the vector of Bigard".

It is important to note that the view that sentences are the most basic unit of meaning is compatible with Davidson's notion of compositionality.

SALIENT POINTS IN DAVIDSON'S STANCE

1. **Compositionality**:- This is the view that sentences are composed of a finite stock of simpler elements that may be sensed and recombined in novel ways, so long as we understand the meanings of those sub-sentential expressions as contributions to the meaning of sentences.

For Davidson, it implies that theory of meaning shows how the meanings of complex expressions are systematically composed from that of simpler expressions.

2. **AVOID NO-MEANING ENTITIES**:- This implies that theory of meaning avoids assigning of unsaturated or incomplete expressions like ideas or intentions to linguistic expressions.

as their meaning. It assigns saturated or complete expressions to meaning so that meaning can have demonstrated use.

3. Radical Interpretation:- This adopts a semantical stance. It relates speakers sentences to the world by assigning them objective truth conditions describing extra-linguistic situations.

4. Indeterminacy of Interpretation:- This means that meaning is essentially intersubjective and objective because most of what speakers say about the world is true of the world.

For Davidson, though radical interpretation widens the field of admissible candidates, it does not identify a unique theory that best satisfies its criteria. Hence the idea of Indeterminacy of interpretation.

Evaluation.

Logical atomism and logical positivism. Comparison.

Outline.

1.0. Introduction.

2.0. Classification of terms.

2.1. Logical atomism

2.2. Logical Positivism.

3.1. Core Thesis and foundational thinkers of Logical atomism.

3.2. Core Thesis and foundational thinkers of Logical positivism.

4.0. Similarities

5.0. Differences

6.0. Evaluation

7.0. Conclusion.

INTRODUCTION.

CLARIFICATION OF TERMS.

LOGICAL ATOMISM.

This phase in analytic philosophy emerged in the 20th Century. It features a turn to ideal language analysis and logical atomism. It was developed by Bertrand Russell and Ludwig Wittgenstein.

Logical atomism is the theory that reality is analyzable into fundamentally simple, indivisible and mutually independent objects or facts. So reality such as ideal language must be identical to the structure of reality. (i.e. it must be precise such that each concrete particular possesses one name).

LOGICAL POSITIVISM.

This phase also emerged in the 20th century, in the second and third decades, particularly in Austria and Great Britain. Its major proponent is Moritz Schlick.

Logical positivism (logical empiricism) is a theory developed to rid philosophy of its metaphysical, non-scientific impurities. It proponents confine knowledge in philosophy to factual assertion and empirical method of science.

CORE THESIS AND FOUNDATIONAL THINKERS OF LOGICAL ATOMISM.

Logical atomism as developed by Bertrand Russell and Wittgenstein, is based on the idea that reality consists of independent, indivisible atomic facts that correspond to elementary propositions in a logically structured language. For them an ideal language or expression that is identical to the structure of reality is known as an atomic sentence.

The atomic sentences are composed of elements and get their meaning by direct correlation with experience (i.e. sense data). Thus, the meaningfulness of such

sentences to human agents depends on human's direct acquaintances, awareness and contact with corresponding sense data. In other words, they establish a correspondence between an atom of language (an atomic proposition) and an atomic fact (the simplest elements of existence).

For logical atomists, the world constitutes separate and independent facts like atomic facts, general facts (marked with all), negative facts and intentional facts (they are non-truth functional proposition that expresses wishes, beliefs wants and likes).

Among the proponents of logical positivism is Bertrand Russell. He defines Logical atomism as the last residue in analysis as such he distinguished between atomic proposition and molecular proposition. For him, each ^{atomic} proposition has a corresponding atomic fact that is knowable to humans through direct acquaintance. He noted that molecular propositions contains atomic propositions and ~~are~~ ^{are} merged by logical connectives.

Kliffenstein on the other hand noted that the proposition a sentence expresses is a set of possible worlds, hence

possible worlds
these are ~~propositions~~ that make a proposition true and possible worlds that make it false. For him with propositions we make ourselves understood, as such misunderstanding arises due to wrong or ambiguous representation of reality.

CORE THESIS AND FOUNDATIONAL THINKERS OF LOGICAL POSITIVISM.

Logical positivism was developed in the 1920's and 1930's by members of the Vienna Circle, including Moritz Schlick, Rudolf Carnap and A.J. Ayer. They sought to eliminate meaningless philosophical speculation and establish a criterion for meaningful statements based on empirical verification.

Their core thesis is that only statements that are either empirically verifiable or logically necessary are meaningful. The uniqueness of this phase of analytic philosophy lies in the unique combination of mathematical logic with empiricism. By its proponents, thereby giving new interpretation to mathematical propositions. For them mathematical theory logic provided the technical basis ^{as is the} for the

Case with Plato's, Pythagorean, Spinoza's and Leibniz's theories.

The proponents of this theory aimed to rid philosophy of its metaphysical and non scientific impurities by deploying principles such as verification principle. They also focused on determining language function in ethical discourse and identifying the differences between the formal truth of logic and mathematics and also the factual truth of empirical sciences.

According to them, since they focused on setting out sufficient conditions of rules for a statement to be meaningful, true or false then an empirical statement is significant/meaningful only if it is verifiable by appeal to experience.

Moritz Schlick distinguished between meaningful and meaningless statements and the role of philosophy as a tool for clarifying scientific knowledge. He insisted ~~that~~ on the narrow sense of verifiability.

which posits that when a statement becomes meaningful to an agent it is as a result of the fact that it expresses a particular state of affairs to the agent who understands the meaning the words in it.

Other thinkers abandoned Moritz's narrow sense of verifiability due to its restrictiveness and endorsed a wider sense of verifiability.

Rudolf Carnap gave a transformed version and upgraded perspective on logical positivism, for him philosophy can be entirely independent of metaphysics and that the ~~verification~~ verifiability principle is the criterion for testing the genuineness of meaningful statements facts.

SIMILARITIES BETWEEN LOGICAL POSITIVISM & LOGICAL ATOMISM.

Though logical positivism and logical atomism are different, they share some similarities. These include.

1. INFLUENCE OF FORMAL LOGIC:- These two schools were influenced by formal logic and sought to bring clarity and precision to philosophical discourse. Being influenced they both aimed to eliminate ambiguity and vagueness from philosophical and scientific discussions by establishing strict criteria for meaningful statements, ensuring that language played a critical role in accurately representing reality.

2. COMMITMENT TO LANGUAGE ANALYSIS:- They both viewed

language as a crucial medium through which reality is understood. Logical atomists sought to break down complex statements into simpler, more fundamental logical structures, while positivists insisted that statements be verifiable through empirical evidence or logical deduction.

3. A SHARED REJECTION OF METAPHYSICS:- The atomist in the rejection of metaphysics sought to reduce reality to its simplest components, dismissing broad metaphysical claims as unnecessary. In the same vein, positivist declared metaphysical statements to be meaningless, since they could not be verified through empirical observation.

DIFFERENCES BETWEEN LOGICAL ATOMISM AND LOGICAL POSITIVISM.

1. APPROACH TO MEANING:- While logical atomism posited that meaning derives from the structure of logical propositions corresponding to fundamental facts. Logical positivism on the other hand held that meaning arises from empirical verification, rejecting statements

that could not be confirmed through sensory experience or logical deduction.

TREATMENT OF

2. **SCIENTIFIC INQUIRY**:- Logical Atomist were primarily concerned with the logical decomposition of propositions to reflect the fundamental structure of reality. The logical positivist on the other hand, were more focused on scientific methodology, seeking to establish philosophy as a rigorous discipline aligned with empirical science. They emphasized verification principle which links philosophy more closely with the empirical sciences.

3. **APPROACH TO LOGIC**:- The Atomist emphasized the logical structure of the world, assuming that reality is made up of independent, atomic facts that correspond to elementary propositions. However, the positivists were less concerned with the ontology of facts and more interested in ensuring that statements about reality met strict empirical or logical criteria.

EVALUATION.